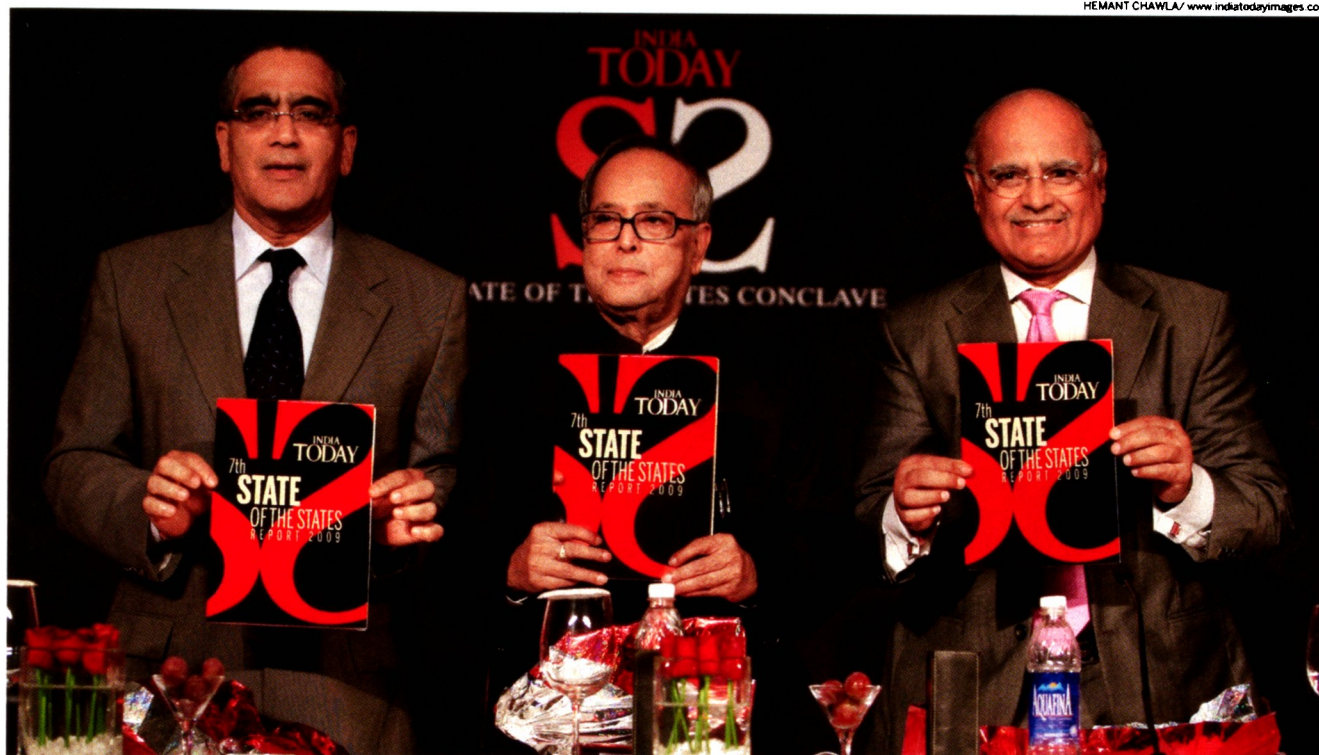


A Manifesto for GROWTH

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It has become an annual confluence of ideas and ideology, a high-powered forum where Union ministers, chief ministers and those in charge of key ministries in strategic states meet to debate the hot-button issues of the day as well as discover the true state of their states. The seventh INDIA TODAY State of the States Conclave, which ranks and awards states on a range of performance parameters, brought together chief ministers and ministers from 16 states and four ministers from the Union Cabinet to discuss critical issues and deliberate on solutions. It was almost as if the National Development Council was holding an open session. The key questions hotly debated this time were: How can we liberate two thirds of the populace living off a fifth of national income? Can the states make

the system deliver on education reforms? And how does India deal with the ugly side of the urban revolution? Chief ministers and senior ministers of the states exchanged notes and ideas with Union Agriculture Minister Sharad Pawar, Human Resource Development Minister Kapil Sibal and Urban Development Minister S. Jaipal Reddy to find solutions to the three most critical imperatives facing India. To achieve the 9 per cent GDP growth dream, India will need growth in agriculture, substantive reforms in education and a blueprint for growing urbanisation. The sessions culminated in an evangelical appeal for inclusive growth from Union Finance Minister Pranab Mukherjee. We present in the following pages excerpts from the lively discussion and the inner dynamics of Centre-state relations. ■

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